

TOP VIRTUAL REALITY HEADSETS TO GO FOR IN 2020

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With innovations happening in technology over the past few years, virtual reality (VR) is gaining prominence throughout the world. It is nothing but usage of computer technology to create a simulated environment. The technology started gaining traction when companies started coming up with VR headsets back in 2016, the first few launches being HTC Vive and Oculus Rift.

The technology hoped to dominate the PC gaming but the products being launched were expensive. Now, companies are coming up with top-notch VR headsets furnished with the Internet of Things (IoT) and are trying to reduce the price of the devices.

Another issue is that VR devices can be injurious to eyes, especially for children. Hence, companies are coming up with new technologies to tackle the situation.

Know the technology you own

The first thing to do before buying a VR headset is ensuring it will work with your current phone or PC. For example, PlayStation VR headset needs PS4 console and PlayStation camera to work, while HTC Vive requires a PC with serious specs, including a powerful processor, at least 4GB RAM, chipset better than

AMD FX 8350 or Intel i5-4590, graphics card equivalent to or better than AMD R9 290 or NVIDIA GTX 970.

Points to consider

As of now, there are only three types of VR headsets available, namely, smartphone-powered, computer-powered and standalone. PC-powered VR headsets are quite expensive and are suitable for high-end gaming. These need a powerful PC with a premium processor, graphics card and high RAM to use.

For a beginner, standalone VR is good in terms of both price and requirements. It gives an experience like a mobile-powered VR headset. Oculus Go is considered to be one of the best standalone VR headsets.

The more immersive the VR headset is, the more you will feel the reality. And to have great immersion, you should have powerful controller(s). A controller acts as a gateway into the VR world. A good controller offers 1:1 positional tracking, which is another vital aspect to consider before buying a VR headset. The more precise the tracking is for a particular headset, the better the VR immersion. Any lag or gap between your position in real life and in-game will adversely affect the experience.

Make sure the VR headset is as light as possible so that you can wear it for a longer duration. Many headsets are quite heavy, thereby making it difficult to wear them even for a minute. Mobile VR headsets are mostly lightweight.

Market options

Given below are some cutting-edge VR headsets available in the market for an amazing immersive experience.

Oculus Quest. Oculus Quest is the company's first all-in-one gaming system built for VR. With this device, you can play almost anywhere with just a VR headset and controller(s).



It can be set up effortlessly whether you are at home or elsewhere. Oculus Quest works with your environment, so you

can play standing or sitting in spaces big or small.

Moreover, it has positional audio built directly into the headset, so you can hear your teammates or what is sneaking up behind you. It translates your movements into VR no matter which way you are facing and provides room-scale tracking without external sensors.

Price: ₹ 28,747 (64GB); ₹ 35,952 (128GB)

Valve Index. Launched in June 2019, this unique VR headset was released by Valve Index Controllers.



It has dual 1440 × 1600 RGB LCDs that provide fifty per cent more sub-pixels than OLEDs, resulting in greater sharpness for the same rendering cost. In addition, the fill factor is also three times better than OLEDs, greatly reduc-